DID YOU KNOW?

Since 2017, AIIMS, New Delhi, has been getting the health ministry's prestigious Kayakalp Award for being the cleanest medical university.

future-ready in the Amrit Kaal, it has been decided to have a special focus on research, adoption and application of AI, drones and robotics," says Srinivas.

AIIMS has also been working to manage patients better; it receives close to 8,000 of them per day for OPD visits alone. The need for prompt interventions, particularly in emergencies, is thus high and the institute plans to increase the capacities of various labs and departments. It has already decided to expand the capacity of its CATH lab given the growing demand for cardio and neuro consultations and procedures. A CATH lab is where tests and procedures, including ablation, angiogram, angioplasty and implantation of pacemakers/ ICDs, are carried out. It is essential for cardio patients and is usually the first port of call. With the patient load for strokes and heart disease increasing in the country, public institutions have to increase their capacities accordingly. "There are so many different patients coming into AIIMS, and as a student, you don't just learn theory here but can religiously practise that theory," says Keerthi Teja, a student.

In terms of courses, there is also a lot to look forward to. The institute plans to set up new disciplines in transplant medicine and spiritual medicine. It has also signed an agreement with the Armed Forces Medical Services to jointly develop a postgraduate course in medicine that will offer practical training to students at Leh (3,500-metre altitude) and Bengaluru (for space exploration). Such training will help high-altitude soldiers who often face acclimatisation issues such as squeezing of blood vessels, swelling of the brain, strokes due to frostbite and so on. There are also plans to set up a 970-bed super-speciality and tertiary care hospital with the Central Armed Police Forces Institute of Medical Sciences (CAPFIMS). In the 15th Finance Commission cycle, the Union Cabinet approved budgetary support of Rs 2,207.5 crore for the institute which is to provide healthcare facilities to all CAPFs employees, their dependents, pensioners, CGHS and Ayushman Bharat-Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana beneficiaries, and the general public.

TOP 5

MEDICAL UNIVERSITIES WITH THE LOWEST TUITION FEES (MS/MD)

RANK	UNIVERSITY	TUITION FEES (ENTIRE COURSE)
1	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS), NEW DELHI	₹702
1	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS), JODHPUR	₹702
1	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS), RAIPUR	₹702
4	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS), RISHIKESH	₹1,000
5	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS), PATNA	₹3,027

TOP 5

MEDICAL UNIVERSITIES WITH THE BEST FACULTY-STUDENT RATIO

RANK	UNIVERSITY	RATIO
1	INSTITUTE OF LIVER & BILIARY SCIENCES, NEW DELHI	2.36
2	JSS ACADEMY OF HIGHER EDUCATION & RESEARCH, MYSURU	1.99
3	NITTE (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY), MANGALURU	1.82
4	NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF MENTAL HEALTH AND NEUROSCIENCES (NIMHANS), BENGALURU	1.72
5	KLE ACADEMY OF HIGHER EDUCATION & RESEARCH (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY), BELAGAVI	1.52

Note: MS/MD student count was considered to calculate the ratio
Total faculty = Permanent faculty + visiting faculty + contractual/ad hoc faculty

Recently, AIIMS, New Delhi, was in the news due to student protests after a nursing student committed suicide in the hostel. The mental health department provided clinical support to teachers and students throughout the Covid pandemic and sources at the institute say there is a possibility that all students will have mandatory counselling sessions in the future to help them cope with the academic and work pressure. It is not just exposure to high-quality medical education that the institute promises, but also an opportunity to develop the personal skills and resilience required to be a doctor. ■